clay ‘for plastering nearly all the structures whether defensive walls, roads, streets, ceremonial ground, or the walls and floors of private houses’. But this changed abruptly in stage four, ‘as if under a royal decree or by a resolute public consensus’.[13] Dholavirans kept dogs as pets, and figurines often depict them with collars. Stray dogs likely roamed the ancient city as they do today in urban India.

Water harvesting drains that fed the city’s reservoirs ran throughout the city. However, perhaps due to the city’s limited supply of water, sewage drains were built only on the citadel, not in the middle or lower town. Most houses in the middle and lower towns had internal drains that emptied outside into portable waste-water pots, like the earthen *matka*s of today. These served as sullage jars—used mainly for fluid waste, human and industrial—which were periodically emptied beyond the city walls into the sea. For defecation, ancient Dholavirans likely went outside the city walls with a lota in hand (as some people still do today in the Dholavira village).



Figure 4. Gate and wall between middle and lower towns